

How to Type Emojis: Windows & Mac Keyboard Shortcuts

On Windows you type an emoji with Win + . , on a Mac with Cmd + Ctrl + Space. In Slack and Teams a colon plus the name is enough, for example :fire:. All three work in any text field, no copy-paste needed.

WINDOWS

Win + . or Win + ; opens the emoji panel

- Works in almost any text field: browser, Word, chat apps
- Use the search box at the top to find a specific emoji fast (e.g. "fire")

MAC

Cmd + Ctrl + Space opens the emoji and symbol viewer

- Recently used emojis show up first, handy for repeats
- Works system-wide, including Mail, Notes, and the browser

IN SLACK AND TEAMS

- Type : followed by a name, e.g. :fire: - suggestions appear automatically
- Both tools learn which emojis you use most and suggest them first
- Custom emoji shortcodes can be set up in either tool

WHY THIS SHORTCUT IS WORTH LEARNING

If you type a lot, you type a lot of emojis too - in Slack messages, team chats, social posts. Copy-pasting from an emoji website costs a few seconds of context switching every single time. The built-in picker is always one keystroke away, no tab switch required.

PRO TIP

The emoji panel remembers your recently used symbols. Force yourself to use the shortcut instead of copy-paste for a week - after that it's muscle memory, same as any other keyboard shortcut. The most useful ones are in the cheat sheets for Windows and Mac.